SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #53 · POLITICS AND GOVERNMENT

“My vote, my voice, and my life don't matter.”

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Where it often comes from

Feeling unheard by officials, lost in large systems, or outvoted again and again can make participation seem pointless. Some also grew up in settings where speaking up was punished. We shrink and stay quiet.

What Scripture teaches

God told Jeremiah, “Seek the prosperity of the city... for if it prospers, you too will prosper.” Jesus said, “Even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows.” Mordecai asked Esther whether she had come to the kingdom for such a time as this. Proverbs says, “He who answers a matter before he hears it...” and urges honest speech: “speak truthfully to his neighbor.” In God’s eyes, every person matters. How and whether we engage civic life is for each of us to decide prayerfully, but we are not nobodies.

> *“And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows”* (Luke 12:7).

Also see

> “Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf, for if it prospers, you too will prosper” (Jeremiah 29:7).

> “Therefore each of you must put off falsehood and speak truthfully to his neighbor, for we are all members of one another” (Ephesians 4:25).

> “For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:13–14).

> “For by the grace given me I say to every one of you: Do not think of yourself more highly than you ought, but think of yourself with sober judgment, according to the measure of faith God has given you” (Romans 12:3).

Common self-statements

- One voice changes nothing.
- No one listens to people like me.
- Why bother?
- The system ignores me.
- I am invisible.
- My life is small.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing my voice has total or no effect.
- Mind reading: Assuming officials do not care.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling powerless and concluding that I am.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that nothing I do matters.

Challenging questions

- Where have I felt unheard, and who was involved?

- What small things have I influenced?
- What does God say about my value?
- Where do I have the most influence: home, church, work, neighborhood?
- What does faithful citizenship look like for me?
- What is one step I can take?

Truth summary

> I matter to God, and my life has influence in places I may overlook. I can pray, vote, speak, and serve as I am able, without carrying the weight of the whole nation.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Worldly
- Will of God
- God, All Knowing
- Hopeless

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My vote, my voice, and my life don't matter"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My vote, my voice, and my life don't matter." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where have I felt unheard?
- ☐ What have I influenced?
- ☐ What does God say?
- ☐ Where is my influence?
- ☐ What is faithful citizenship?
- ☐ What is my step?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God knows me and values me.
- ☐ I am worth more than many sparrows.
- ☐ My life has influence.
- ☐ I can seek the good of my city.
- ☐ I can speak truthfully.
- ☐ I do not carry the nation.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Luke 12:7
  "And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows."
- ☐ Jeremiah 29:7
  "Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf, for if it prospers, you too will prosper."
- ☐ Ephesians 4:25
  "Therefore each of you must put off falsehood and speak truthfully to his neighbor, for we are all members of one another."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Where I make a difference: Each week, note one small way you contributed.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Luke 12:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am worth more than many sparrows, so my life matters.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] List your circles. Write where you have influence.
- [ ] Do one thing. Vote, volunteer, or write a note.
- [ ] Speak truthfully. Say one honest word kindly.
- [ ] Pray for your city. Pray by name for places and people.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My vote, my voice, and my life don't matter": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Where I make a difference
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My vote, my voice, and my life don't matter.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I feel small and unheard. Thank You for counting me valuable. Show me where I can serve, speak, and pray, and give me peace about the rest. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.